Tic-Tac-BRO!

The Survival Guide for Younger Siblings

2–4 players, plus one older brother who will not be told no.

Your big brother says tic-tac-toe is for babies, so he "fixed" it. Everyone gets their own board, you play **cards** to place markers on **anyone's** board, and he runs his own deck of pure chaos. He's bet he can beat the whole table *by himself*. Prove him wrong.

1. Overview

The goal of any tic tac toe game is to get 3 in a line. In Tic-Tac-Bro!, **you have to do this 5 times to win.** Instead of 1 vs 1: every player (aka. sibling) has their own board, and each player takes a turn — including your big brother.

Each sibling gets a board, markers in their own color, and a scorecard. You only score on **your own board** by getting **3 of your own markers in a line** to earn **1 point**. After scoring a point, the line is cleared by removing the markers from your board.

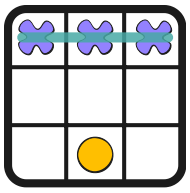
Big Bro plays too. He sits at the table like a player, but he has no board and no hand. A handler flips his cards for him, and he drops his red markers onto *everyone's* boards. Whenever a line with **his marker** in it fills up, he scores a point, no matter whose board it is or who filled the last cell. Big Bro does not need 3 in a line to score. He just waits for a line to fill up with one of his markers in it.

Everyone's boards are fair game. On your turn you play a card to place a marker. Put it on your board to build toward a line, or on a rival's board to get in their way. A line of your color on *someone else's* board is cleared without a point for you.

You're racing your siblings to **5 points to win**, but Big Bro is racing *all* of you. He wins at **10** points with 2 players, **15** with 3, or **20** with 4. Block each other, but keep an eye on him: if he scores too much, **everybody loses**.

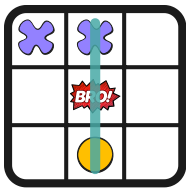
2. Scoring: When a Line Fills Up

Whenever a line becomes **full**, on **any** board, on **anyone's** turn (Big Bro's too), look at its three markers:



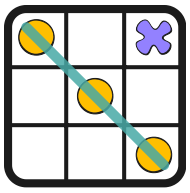
You +1

All **yours**, on **your board**. Move your token up 1, then **remove** the line.



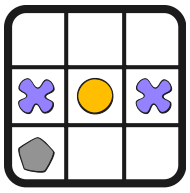
Big Bro +1

Any red in it, on **any** board. Big Bro scores, then **remove** the line.



No points

All **one player's**, on **someone else's** board. **Remove** the line. Nobody scores.



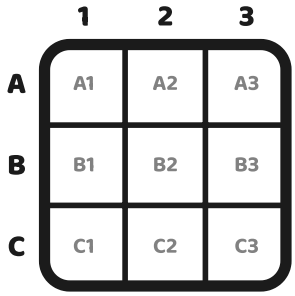
Jammed

Mixed, no red. Nothing happens. The line **stays**, stuck.

- **Removed markers** go back to their owners.
- **Big Bro doesn't need a match.** One red marker is enough, even if *you* filled the last cell.
- **Two lines fill at once?** Check each one.

Tip: look for red first. Two of your markers in a line? Fill the third for a point. Two of a rival's on *their* board? Fill the gap with anything else to jam it. But if Big Bro's marker is in that line, filling it just hands him a point.

Reading a Board



Every cell has a name: its **row letter** (A, B, C, top to bottom) and **column number** (1, 2, 3, left to right).

A **line** is any row, column, or diagonal.

Fine Print

- **"Every player"** and **"every board"** mean the siblings. His cards never affect him.
- If a card gives someone a choice, it's the **affected player's** choice, not the handler's.



Big Bro says: "I'm not a sore loser. I'm a *strategic reevaluator*. Rematch."

Setup & turns on the back →

3. Set Up

1. **Shuffle the decks.** Shuffle each of the three decks separately. Tell them apart by their backs:



Sibling Deck



Big Bro Deck



Orders Deck

2. **Pick a color.** Each player takes the **markers** and **scorecard** for one color: ✖ ● ⬟ ▲. Each player puts a token on their scorecard's **0**.
3. **Take a board.** Each player puts a tic-tac-toe board in front of them.
4. **Seat Big Bro** between two players. His spot gets his **scoreboard** (token on 0), his red BRO! markers, and the **Big Bro** and **Orders** decks, face down. Pick a **handler** to run his turns, ideally someone **next to him**.
5. **Deal.** Deal **3 Sibling cards** to each player, and put the rest of the Sibling Deck face down in the middle.
6. **Go!** The player **clockwise from Big Bro** goes first. Big Bro always goes **last**.

4. Taking Turns

Turns go **clockwise**. Every player takes a turn, then Big Bro.

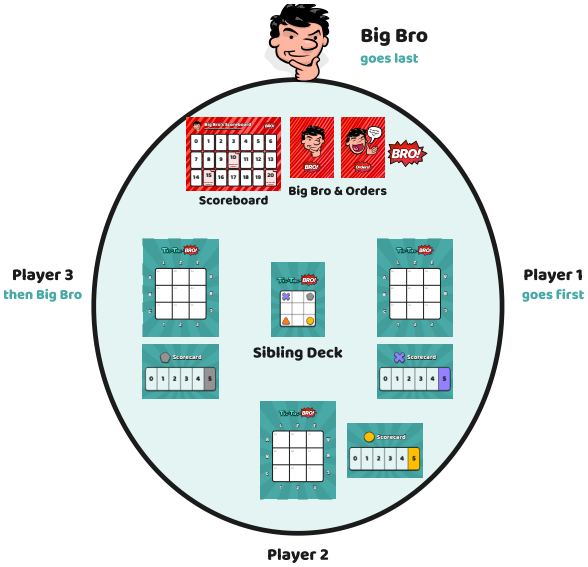
Your Turn

1. **Play one card** from your hand.
2. **Do what it says.** Every marker you place is **yours**. Some cards let you play on **someone else's board**, to block them from scoring.
3. **Check for full lines** on that board (see **Scoring**, on the front).
4. **Draw back up to 3 cards.**

> **Bad hand?** Instead of playing, discard your whole hand and draw 3 new cards. That's your turn. Do it whenever you're stuck, or just hate your hand.

Any deck runs out? Shuffle its discards to make a new one.

The Table

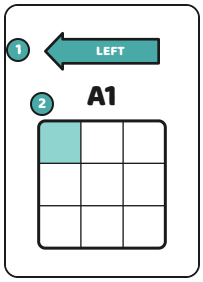


5. Big Bro's Turn

The handler **flips the top Big Bro card** and does exactly what it says. That's his whole turn. He has no hand and no board.

The Orders Deck

When a Big Bro card says **"draw an Order,"** flip the top Orders card, use the part the card asks for, then discard it.



1. **Direction:** the arrow. **Left** is clockwise, **right** is counterclockwise. Skip Big Bro's seat when passing.
2. **Cell:** the coordinate (here **A1**). It means that same cell on every board.

How He Scores

1 point for every full line with his marker in it, and whenever a card says **"Big Bro scores."** Move his token on his scoreboard.